

Comprehensive Strategic Analysis of ESG Disclosures and Sustainability Performance: Berli Jucker Public Company Limited (2014–2023)

The corporate landscape of Southeast Asia has undergone a profound transformation over the last decade, transitioning from a focus on philanthropic corporate social responsibility to a rigorous, data-driven framework of Environmental, Social, and Governance (ESG) integration. At the forefront of this evolution in the Kingdom of Thailand is Berli Jucker Public Company Limited (BJC). This report provides an exhaustive examination of BJC's ESG trajectory between 2014 and 2023, analyzing how one of Thailand's oldest trading institutions has professionalized its sustainability disclosures to achieve global leadership status within the retail and industrial sectors.

Organizational Profile and Corporate Identification

Berli Jucker Public Company Limited, identified on the Stock Exchange of Thailand by the ticker BJC.BK, represents a cornerstone of the Thai industrial and services sector.¹ Established in 1882, the company has transitioned through multiple economic eras, eventually becoming a prominent subsidiary of the TCC Corporation Company Limited.³ Its headquarters are located at Berli Jucker House, 99 Sukhumvit 42 Road, Khlong Toei, Bangkok 10110.¹

The company's operations are vertically integrated and highly diversified, structured primarily through four supply chains that define its materiality profile. The Packaging Supply Chain is a major regional player in the design and manufacture of glass containers, aluminum cans, and rigid plastic packaging.³ The Consumer Supply Chain encompasses the production and distribution of food and non-food items, including iconic brands such as Tasto, Dozo, and Parrot soap.³ The Healthcare & Technical Supply Chain provides a vital link in the distribution of pharmaceuticals and medical equipment, while the Modern Retail Supply Chain, anchored by Big C Supercenter Public Company Limited, manages a massive network of hypermarkets and convenience stores across ASEAN.³

BJC is classified under the Services sector and the Commerce industry within the SET categorization.² As of 2025, the company maintains a market capitalization of approximately 56.91 billion THB, with a complex shareholding structure where 25% of shares are held by free-float investors.¹ The legal and operational identity of BJC is verified through the official factsheets of the Stock Exchange of Thailand and corporate investor relations disclosures.¹

Macro-Economic and Regulatory Context of the Thai Capital Market

To understand BJC's ESG disclosures, one must first consider the regulatory environment governed by the Securities and Exchange Commission (SEC) of Thailand and the Stock Exchange of Thailand (SET). Throughout the period of 2014–2023, Thailand has been a regional leader in sustainability reporting mandates. The SET has consistently moved toward harmonizing local requirements with international standards, most notably through the introduction of the "One Report" (Form 56-1 One Report), which mandates the integration of ESG data into annual financial disclosures.⁶

The Thai capital market's focus on ESG was further catalyzed by the launch of the Thailand Sustainability Investment (THSI) list, now the SET ESG Ratings, which evaluates companies on their ability to manage material sustainability issues.² BJC's performance in this local index has served as a prerequisite for its later inclusion in global indices such as the Dow Jones Sustainability Indices (DJSI) and MSCI ESG Ratings.⁵ This regulatory backdrop provided the necessary "compliance floor" from which BJC could build its voluntary "performance ceiling."

Longitudinal ESG Timeline Analysis 2014–2023

The evolution of BJC's sustainability reporting can be categorized into three distinct strategic phases: the CSR and Acquisition Phase (2014–2016), the Framework Integration Phase (2017–2019), and the Global Leadership Phase (2020–2023).

Phase One: CSR and Acquisition (2014–2016)

During the early part of this decade, BJC's sustainability efforts were characterized by Corporate Social Responsibility (CSR) activities and the management of high-stakes mergers and acquisitions. In 2014, the company's reporting was primarily focused on philanthropic contributions and basic compliance with the SEC's environmental and social disclosure requirements.⁶

The most significant event of this phase was the acquisition of Big C Supercenter in 2016. This pivot toward modern retail fundamentally altered BJC's ESG profile, shifting its primary social focus from industrial labor to consumer safety, supply chain transparency, and retail waste management.⁹ This acquisition necessitated a more robust governance framework to manage the expanded workforce and the environmental footprint of hundreds of retail locations.⁴

Phase Two: Framework Integration (2017–2019)

In this transitional period, BJC began to move away from disparate CSR reports toward integrated disclosures. By 2017, the company had improved its financial stability, as evidenced by a credit rating upgrade to BBB+ from Tris Rating, which the company linked to its stable

operational management.¹⁰ In 2018 and 2019, BJC began adopting themes such as "The Green Big Tree Growing Sustainably Together," signaling a strategic intent to align its diverse supply chains under a unified environmental banner.¹¹

The company used the 2019 period to lay the groundwork for high-transparency reporting, utilizing its annual reports (Form 56-1) as a vehicle for disclosure while preparing for its first standalone Sustainability Report (SR).⁶

Phase Three: Global Leadership (2020–2023)

The current decade has seen BJC emerge as an international ESG benchmark. In 2020, BJC published its first comprehensive Sustainability Report in accordance with the Global Reporting Initiative (GRI) Standards.⁸ This year also marked its first inclusion in the Thailand Sustainability Investment index, a recognition it has maintained for consecutive years.⁸

The years 2021 through 2023 saw a rapid succession of global recognitions. In 2021, BJC was selected as a member of the Dow Jones Sustainability Indices (DJSI) Emerging Markets for the first time.⁸ By 2022, its MSCI ESG Rating was upgraded to "A," reflecting its resilience to industry-specific ESG risks.⁸ In 2023, BJC reached its peak performance, achieving the highest DJSI score in the history of the Food & Staples Retailing industry globally (92/100) and receiving an "AA" upgrade from MSCI.⁵

Year	Key ESG Milestone	Framework / Agency	Strategic Impact	Source
2014	Publication of CSR Report	SEC Thailand	Establishment of baseline social metrics	⁶
2016	Acquisition of Big C	Corporate Governance	Transformation of ESG materiality profile	⁹
2020	First Standalone SR	GRI Standards	Professionalization of ESG disclosures	¹²
2021	First DJSI Inclusion	S&P Global	Benchmark against global	⁸

			retail peers	
2022	MSCI Rating "A"	MSCI ESG Research	Increased institutional investor confidence	⁸
2023	World's Highest DJSI Score	S&P Global	Global sector leadership recognition	⁵

Thematic Pillar Analysis: Environmental Stewardship and Climate Strategy

BJC's environmental strategy is consolidated under the "Better Living" pillar of its ESG framework, which addresses the dual challenges of industrial manufacturing and high-volume retail.⁵

The 1+5 Strategy for Net Zero

Central to BJC's environmental commitment is its "1+5 Strategy," which targets the achievement of Net Zero GHG emissions by the year 2050.⁵ The "1" represents the primary goal of carbon neutrality, while the "5" refers to specific operational focus areas: energy efficiency, water stewardship, waste management, sustainable packaging, and biodiversity.⁵

In 2023, BJC spearheaded the "Big Tree Planting Project," which involved planting 20,000 trees across 40 acres as a nature-based solution for carbon sequestration.⁵ Beyond sequestration, the company has focused on aggressive decarbonization of its supply chain. For the Packaging Supply Chain, this involves the optimization of glass furnaces and the transition to renewable energy sources, such as solar rooftops for manufacturing plants and Big C retail outlets.⁵

Greenhouse Gas (GHG) Accounting and Intensity

BJC utilizes a technical "GHG Accounting Manual" to track its emissions profile across Scope 1 (direct emissions), Scope 2 (indirect energy emissions), and Scope 3 (value chain emissions).¹² The company's performance in these areas is a critical component of its CDP (formerly Carbon Disclosure Project) disclosures, where it earned an "A List" rating for Climate Change in 2025.⁸

To quantify its decoupling of environmental impact from economic growth, BJC tracks GHG intensity. The standard formulation for this metric, often reported in its annual disclosures, follows the relationship between total emissions and revenue:

$$I_{GHG} = \frac{\text{Scope 1 Emissions} + \text{Scope 2 Emissions}}{\text{Total Revenue (THB)}}$$

The analysis of BJC's data indicates a steady trend toward lowering this intensity, particularly through energy-saving initiatives in its aluminum and glass production facilities.⁵

Water Management and Supply Chain Resilience

For a company with significant food processing and industrial manufacturing interests, water is a highly material issue. BJC assesses its water-related risks under international standards such as ISO 14001:2015.¹⁶ Within the Consumer Supply Chain, specifically Berli Jucker Foods (BJF), water is critical for the processing of agricultural raw materials.¹⁷

The company has implemented water recycling protocols that have reduced wastewater by up to 15% annually in specific sites.¹⁷ Furthermore, BJC conducts water stress assessments for its critical suppliers, particularly those providing potatoes for snack production. Five critical potato suppliers have been identified as operating in regions of high or extremely high water stress, prompting BJC to provide training on efficient irrigation and moisture-control technologies to ensure long-term supply stability.¹⁷

Circular Economy and Packaging Innovation

The Packaging Supply Chain serves as both a source of environmental impact and a provider of sustainable solutions. BJC focuses on the "Three Rs" (Reduce, Reuse, Recycle) by developing lightweight glass containers and increasing the cullet (recycled glass) ratio in its furnace inputs.⁵ In its retail operations, the company has implemented circular waste management practices, including the recycling of packaging materials and the conversion of food waste into fertilizer, which was highlighted during the 2023 Sustainability Expo (SX 2023).¹⁸

Thematic Pillar Analysis: Social Responsibility and Human Capital Management

BJC's social pillar, "Caring for Community," addresses its responsibility toward its nearly 48,000 employees and the millions of customers it serves daily.⁴

Labor Rights and Gender Equality

The company maintains a rigorous Human Rights Policy, which was updated in July 2023 to ensure alignment with the United Nations Universal Declaration of Human Rights (UDHR) and the International Labour Organization (ILO) standards.²⁰ This policy applies across all subsidiaries and establishes a framework for preventing human rights violations, including forced labor, child labor, and discrimination.²⁰

A significant achievement in BJC's social disclosure is its recognition in the 2024 Equileap Gender Equality Report, where it was ranked first in Thailand and eleventh globally among emerging market companies.⁸ The company reports on its gender pay gap (GRI 405-2) and has high representation of women in management roles, which has been a driving factor in its MSCI rating upgrades.⁸

Occupational Health and Safety (OHS)

With a large industrial and retail workforce, OHS is a top-tier material topic. BJC reports on work-related injuries and fatalities (GRI 403-9) and conducts regular safety audits through its internal audit department and third-party verifiers.¹⁵ The company's "WINNING" cultural framework promotes a "zero-accident" mindset, and performance in safety metrics is often tied to executive remuneration.¹²

Community Contribution and Development

BJC leverages its retail network to drive social value through local sourcing and community support programs. The company expands into rural areas not only for business growth but also to integrate local products into its supply chain.⁵ During the 2023 period, BJC prioritized direct purchasing from local farmers and collaborated with hospitals to provide telemedicine and preventive health services to underserved populations.⁵

Thematic Pillar Analysis: Governance, Ethics, and Risk Resilience

The "Joint Success" pillar of BJC's ESG framework is designed to ensure that the company's growth is anchored in transparency and ethical conduct.⁵

Board Governance and ESG Oversight

The Board of Directors (BOD) at BJC is actively involved in setting the sustainability agenda. The board is composed of a diverse group of professionals, including significant representation from independent directors who chair the Audit, Nomination, and Remuneration committees.²¹

Key figures on the board include:

- **Mr. Thapana Sirivadhanabhakdi** (Non-Executive Director): Holds multiple mandates across the TCC Group, ensuring strategic alignment within the broader conglomerate.²¹
- **Prof. Pirom Kamolratanakul, M.D.** (Independent Director): Provides oversight on ethical and social dimensions, particularly in healthcare.²¹
- **Ms. Potjanee Thanavarani** (Independent Director): Brings expertise in financial regulation and risk management.²¹

The BOD utilizes Key Performance Indicators (KPIs) and regular sustainability audits to monitor

the integration of ESG principles into daily operations.²¹ This proactive approach is reflected in the company's high Governance Rating (CGR score ≥ 90) from the Thai Institute of Directors.²

Ethics, Anti-Corruption, and Whistleblowing

BJC maintains a zero-tolerance policy regarding bribery and corruption.¹² The company has established a comprehensive "Codes of Business Conduct" and a "Supplier Code of Conduct," both of which are mandatory for all business partners.¹² Compliance is monitored through an Investigation Committee and an Inspection Taskforce, which review complaints submitted through the company's whistleblowing channels.²⁰ In 2023, the company conducted several ethics implementation bootcamps to ensure that the code of conduct was understood at all levels of the organization.²

Cybersecurity and Data Privacy

As the Modern Retail Supply Chain becomes increasingly digitized through online-to-offline (O2O) platforms and loyalty programs, cybersecurity has become a critical governance risk. BJC has implemented a "Personal Data Protection Policy" in compliance with the Thai Personal Data Protection Act (PDPA).¹² The company holds an ISO 27001 certification for its information security management systems, providing assurance to millions of Big C customers that their personal data is protected.¹²

Framework Adoption and Disclosure Standards

BJC's commitment to high-quality disclosure is demonstrated through its adoption of multiple international reporting frameworks.

Global Reporting Initiative (GRI)

The company's annual Sustainability Report has been prepared in accordance with the GRI Standards since 2020.⁵ The 2023 report utilized the GRI 2021 Universal Standards, covering 100% of BJC's operations in Thailand.⁵ The GRI Content Index allows for clear mapping of disclosures related to economic performance, environmental impact, and social equity, ensuring comparability for global investors.⁵

Task Force on Climate-related Financial Disclosures (TCFD)

BJC integrates TCFD recommendations into its reporting to address the financial implications of climate change. This includes disclosing how the board oversees climate risks and the specific strategies used to mitigate transition and physical risks (e.g., the impact of extreme weather on logistics and agricultural sourcing).¹²

Sustainability Accounting Standards Board (SASB)

For its retail operations, BJC aligns with the SASB standards for the *Food & Staples Retailing* industry. This framework focuses on specific metrics such as food waste diversion, the energy efficiency of retail facilities, and the safety of private-label products.⁵

Dow Jones Sustainability Indices (DJSI) and MSCI

BJC's performance in the S&P Global Corporate Sustainability Assessment (CSA) is a cornerstone of its ESG profile. With a score of 92/100 in 2023, BJC was named an "Industry Mover" and an industry leader (Top 1%).⁵ Simultaneously, its MSCI "AA" rating highlights its leading practices in corporate governance and labor management compared to regional peers in the retail-food and staples industry.⁵

Independent Assurance and Data Reliability

A critical component of expert-level ESG reporting is the presence of external verification. BJC commissions LRQA (formerly Lloyd's Register Quality Assurance) to provide independent assurance for its sustainability reports.¹⁵

Scope of Assurance

The 2024 assurance engagement covered the 2023 reporting year and included a limited level of assurance for environmental and social indicators.¹⁵ LRQA verified:

- **Energy and Emissions:** Verification of Scope 1 and Scope 2 GHG emissions, as well as total energy consumption.¹⁵
- **Waste:** Verification of waste diverted from and directed to disposal, specifically including food loss and waste data.¹⁵
- **Social Metrics:** Verification of work-related injuries and the gender pay gap.¹⁵
- **Supply Chain:** Verification of new suppliers screened using environmental and social criteria.¹⁵

Auditor Findings and Opinions

LRQA's opinion confirmed that BJC's disclosures were materially correct and that the company met the requirements of the GRI 2021 standards.¹⁵ However, the auditors noted that while GHG emissions data (Scope 1 and 2) met the criteria for "reasonable assurance," BJC should continue to improve its data collection tools for food loss and waste to increase accuracy in future cycles.¹⁵ This demonstrates a transparent audit trail where the company acknowledges its "data gaps" while striving for continuous improvement.

Reference Table with Credibility Assessment

The findings presented in this report are supported by a range of primary and secondary

sources, as detailed in the table below.

#	Reference (APA 7th edition format)	Source Type	Credibility Score (0–10)	Justification for Score	Relevance to Query
1	Berli Jucker Public Company Limited. (2024). <i>Sustainability Report 2023</i> .	Primary (Official Report)	10	Direct corporate filing, externally assured by LRQA, following GRI standards.	Extremely High
2	Stock Exchange of Thailand. (2025). <i>BJC Quote and Company Profile Factsheet</i> .	Primary (Exchange)	10	Official regulatory and market data platform for the Thai capital market.	Extremely High
3	S&P Global Sustainable1. (2023). <i>Berli Jucker Public Company Limited ESG Score</i> .	Secondary (Rating Agency)	9	Recognized global benchmark provider with a standardized CSA methodology .	High

4	MSCI ESG Research LLC. (2023). <i>ESG Ratings Report: Berli Jucker.</i>	Secondary (Rating Agency)	9	Leading provider of ESG indices used by institutional investors globally.	High
5	LRQA. (2024). <i>Independent Assurance Statement for BJC Sustainability Report.</i>	Third-Party (Audit)	10	Objective verification of non-financial data by an international auditing firm.	Extremely High
6	SEC Thailand. (2020). <i>Tender Offer for Securities of White Group.</i>	Primary (Regulator)	10	Official legal document filed with the national regulator for securities.	High
7	Equileap. (2024). <i>Gender Equality in Emerging Markets Report.</i>	Secondary (Research)	8	Respected specialist research firm focusing on diversity and inclusion metrics.	High
8	Tris Rating Co., Ltd. (2017). <i>Credit Rating</i>	Secondary (Rating Agency)	8	Established regional credit rating agency with a	Medium

	Announcement for Berli Jucker.			transparent methodology	
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Transparency, Limitations, and External Verification

The analysis provided herein reflects data accurate as of the knowledge cutoff date of March 19, 2026. While the reporting period of 2014–2023 is extensively covered, certain historical CSR reports from 2015 were noted as "unavailable" in the digital archive.⁶ Furthermore, data related to Scope 3 emissions is currently subject to "limited assurance," indicating that the quantification of indirect value chain emissions is still in an early, evolving stage.¹⁵

Readers are encouraged to verify the claims made in this report through the following authoritative external databases:

- SET ESG Ratings**
Database:(<https://www.set.or.th/en/market/product/stock/quote/BJC/sustainability/esg-rating>)
- BJC Investor Relations Disclosure Portal:**
<https://investor.bjc.co.th/en/downloads/annual-reports>
- S&P Global ESG Scores Results:**
<https://www.spglobal.com/sustainable1/en/scores/results?cid=4545794>

Strategic Synthesis and Future Outlook

The decade between 2014 and 2023 has been a period of remarkable transformation for Berli Jucker Public Company Limited. From its origins as a diversified industrial conglomerate, BJC has successfully integrated modern retail through the Big C acquisition and elevated its sustainability performance to the highest global standards. The core of BJC’s success lies in its ability to reconcile the high-intensity energy requirements of the Packaging Supply Chain with the social and logistical complexities of the Modern Retail Supply Chain.

The achievement of a 92/100 score from DJSI and an "AA" rating from MSCI is not merely a symbolic victory; it reflects a deep-seated integration of ESG into the company’s capital allocation and risk management processes. The "1+5 Strategy" serves as a roadmap for the next twenty-five years, transitioning from mere efficiency gains to a comprehensive net-zero business model.

However, the future is not without challenges. As Thailand’s regulatory environment moves toward mandatory IFRS S1 and S2 disclosures, BJC will need to further refine its Scope 3 reporting and nature-related risk assessments (TNFD). The company’s ability to maintain its

leadership position will depend on its capacity to manage the "Double Materiality" of ESG—mitigating its impact on the planet while building financial resilience against the physical and transitional risks of a changing global climate.

In conclusion, Berli Jucker stands as a premier example of how family-controlled conglomerates in emerging markets can successfully institutionalize ESG principles. Through a combination of robust governance, international framework adoption, and third-party assurance, BJC has not only secured its position in the Thai capital market but has also set a global benchmark for the food and staples retailing industry.

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